Real & Virtual Images

Exam code: 0625 & 0972

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Help me understand

Real images & virtual images

- Images produced by lenses can be one of two types:
  - A real image
  - A virtual image
- Images can be described **compared to their object** as:
  - **Enlarged**/same size/**diminished**
  - **Upright/inverted**
  - **Real/virtual**

Real images

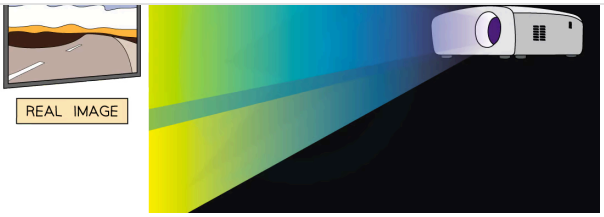
- A real image is defined as:

An image that is formed when the light rays from an object converge and meet each other and can be projected onto a screen

- A real image is one produced by the **convergence** of light towards a focus
- Real images are always **inverted**
- Real images can be projected onto pieces of paper or screens
  - An example of a real image is the image formed on a cinema screen

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

A real image



A real image can be projected onto a screen

Virtual images

- A virtual image is defined as:

An image that is formed when the light rays from an object do not meet but appear to meet behind the lens and cannot be projected onto a screen

- A virtual image is formed by the **divergence** of light away from a point
- Virtual images are always **upright**
- Virtual images **cannot** be projected onto a piece of paper or a screen
  - An example of a virtual image is a person's reflection in a mirror

A virtual image

A reflection in a mirror is an example of a virtual image

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